

A photograph of Stephen Hawking seated in his custom-built motorized wheelchair. He is wearing a dark suit and glasses, looking slightly to his right. The wheelchair is black with large, treaded wheels and various mechanical components visible. In the background, a large, vibrant image of the Earth from space dominates the left side, showing swirling blue and white clouds. To the right, a smaller, less detailed image of Earth is visible. The overall scene is set against a dark background, suggesting a stage or a studio environment.

“We are just an advanced breed of monkeys on a minor planet of a very average star. But we can understand the Universe. That makes us something very special.”

Stephen Hawking in an interview with the German newspaper *Der Spiegel*, 1988

In demand

A popular icon with an Oscar-winning movie—*The Theory of Everything*—made about his life, Hawking remains highly in demand for talks and lectures. Here, he gives a speech at NASA's 50th birthday event in 2008.